

Food Truck Event Profit Calculator

Product Decision Record (PDR) v0.3

Investigation Question

What information does a food truck owner actually need to confidently decide whether an event is worth attending?

FTC-PDR-001

The application should feel like a purpose-built desktop tool rather than a traditional spreadsheet.

FTC-PDR-002

The application's primary goal is to help food truck owners make better event decisions while keeping the workflow as simple and intuitive as possible.

FTC-PDR-003

The calculator provides financial analysis and factual warnings to help customers make informed event decisions. The final decision always belongs to the customer.

FTC-PDR-004

On first use, the application opens to the Defaults screen so the customer can configure reusable business information before evaluating events.

FTC-PDR-005

After initial setup is complete, the application opens directly to the Event Calculator screen.

FTC-PDR-006

The application contains three primary customer-facing screens: Defaults, Event Calculator, and Comparison. Each screen serves a distinct purpose in the customer's workflow.

FTC-PDR-007

Intermediate calculations and implementation details remain hidden from the customer. The calculation methodology is documented separately so customers can understand how every result is derived.

FTC-PDR-008

Reusable business settings are stored in the Defaults screen.

FTC-PDR-009

Every reusable default can be overridden for an individual event without changing the saved default.

FTC-PDR-010

Changes made to reusable defaults must never silently overwrite event-specific overrides.

FTC-PDR-011

Customers can save the results of individual event analyses for later comparison.

FTC-PDR-012

Every saved event records the event title, date, time, and location solely to help the customer recognize and compare saved scenarios. This information does not participate in financial calculations.

FTC-PDR-013

The Comparison screen exists solely to allow customers to review and compare previously saved event analyses.

FTC-PDR-014

The Product Decision Record is the authoritative source for approved product decisions. Architecture specifications, implementation documentation, and build instructions are derived from it rather than conversation history.

FTC-PDR-015

The application architecture is written only after the major product and user experience decisions have been approved and recorded in the Product Decision Record.

FTC-PDR-016

The application never hides uncertainty. When customer inputs are estimates, calculated results are presented as estimates derived from those assumptions.

FTC-PDR-017

Whenever practical, the application identifies the primary factors limiting profitability rather than only reporting the final profit or loss.

FTC-PDR-018

Every customer-facing feature must directly support the question: 'Should I attend this event?' Features that do not materially improve that decision should not be included.

FTC-PDR-019

The product is a standalone local application delivered through a local web interface rather than a cloud-hosted website.

FTC-PDR-020

The application stores customer data locally on the customer's computer by default. Customer data is not transmitted to external servers as part of normal operation.

FTC-PDR-021

Persistent application data is stored in a relational database rather than browser storage or manually managed data files.

FTC-PDR-022

The application architecture separates the user interface, business logic, and data storage into distinct layers to support maintainability and future expansion.

FTC-PDR-023

The user interface is delivered through standard web technologies (HTML, CSS, and JavaScript) rendered locally within the customer's web browser.

FTC-PDR-024

The application is served by a lightweight local application server running on the customer's computer. No internet connection is required for normal operation.

FTC-PDR-025

The application's primary storage mechanism is independent of any specific web browser. Customer data remains available regardless of which supported browser is used to access the local application.

FTC-PDR-026

The application prioritizes offline reliability. Internet connectivity must never be required for the core workflow of evaluating, saving, or comparing events.